

1.4 Wired and wireless networks

Learners should have studied the following:

- types of networks:
 - LAN (Local Area Network)
 - WAN (Wide Area Network)
- factors that affect the performance of networks
- the different roles of computers in a client-server and a peer-to-peer network
- the hardware needed to connect stand-alone computers into a Local Area Network:
 - wireless access points
 - routers/switches
 - NIC (Network Interface Controller/Card)
 - transmission media
- the internet as a worldwide collection of computer networks:
 - DNS (Domain Name Server)
 - hosting
 - the cloud
- the concept of virtual networks.